THE ONLY CURE + FIELD SURGERY

PLAYER GUIDE

Version 3.3.6 · Project Zomboid Build 42 · Singleplayer and multiplayer

Everything you need to survive a bite, cut the limb off properly, heal, and get back on your feet (or onto a mechanical one). Every box, tab and line marked like this is clickable. Use the bookmarks panel of your PDF reader to jump around.



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Fork of ZioPao's The Only Cure (GPL-3.0). Guide made for The Only Cure+ by Nexconker.

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I GOT BITTEN!

Click a box to read more

1. WHERE IS THE BITE?



Hand, forearm, upper arm, foot, calf or thigh: it can be cut off. Head, neck, torso or groin: no surgery can save you.

GO >

2. EXAMINE THE WOUND



Health panel, right-click the wound. Needs First Aid 2 or the Field Amputation Guide. A scratch may be clean.

GO >

3. YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME



Amputate inside the cure window (first 20% of the infection) and it is gone. Up to 40% it is a gamble.

GO >

4. GATHER THE KIT



Tourniquet worn, disinfectant, painkillers, a blade, a saw, needle and thread, a bandage.

GO >

5. OPERATE



Saw > Amputate > limb, or health panel. Read the risk window, then press Operate. Somewhere closed: screams carry.

GO >

6. FIRST HOURS



Shock and blood loss. Bandage, rest, eat and drink. Keep the stump clean or sepsis starts.

GO >

7. HEALING



The stump closes in 5 to 10 days (faster with skill). Cauterizing at a fire closes it at once.

GO >

8. BACK ON YOUR FEET



Crutch for a leg, then a prosthesis: arm base + attachment, or a prosthetic leg.

GO >

COMMON MISTAKES

- Operating in the open: each scream is heard up to **25 tiles** away. Painkillers and alcohol make it quieter.
- No tourniquet: heavy bleeding while sawing (+15% failure chance). Make one from ripped sheets or a belt and a stick, and **wear it** on that limb.
- Waiting too long: past 40% of the infection the surgery no longer cures you.
- Leaving the stump dirty: sepsis. Clean it from the health panel and keep it bandaged.

NOT SURE IT IS INFECTED?

Bites are the dangerous ones, but scratches and lacerations can carry the virus too. Use Examine Wound: doctors get a clear answer, everyone else gets a hunch. Symptoms (chills, fever, burning wound) also tell you it is in your blood.

> **TIP** The surgery window shows every missing item before you start, and the risk if you are skilled enough to judge it. Pressing **No** costs nothing.

INFECTION & DIAGNOSIS

EXAMINE WOUND

Health panel > right-click a part with a bite, scratch, cut or deep wound > **Examine Wound**.

- Needs **First Aid 2** (sandbox *DiagnosisMinDoctor*) or having read the **Field Amputation Guide**.
- Takes about 250 ticks, less with First Aid. Gives First Aid XP.
- Accuracy grows with First Aid and with how far the infection has gone. A miss can say "unsure" or the wrong answer.
- First Aid 4+: clear wording ("infected with the Knox virus" / "looks clean"). Below that: a hunch ("Probably infected").
- The health panel remembers the result: *Examined: infected (3 h ago)*.

GOOD TO KNOW The guide is literature: reading it teaches the surgery. Doctors, nurses, paramedics, vets and medics start knowing it. It spawns in clinics, hospitals, bookstores and libraries.



WHAT CAN BE CUT

- Hand, forearm, upper arm
- Foot, lower leg, thigh
- Not the head, neck, torso or groin: a bite there cannot be cut out.

THE CURE WINDOW

Amputate the infected limb before 20% and you are cured. From 20% to 40% the chance drops to zero. After that the surgery no longer helps.



% = progress of the vanilla Knox infection (sandbox CureWindow 20, LateGambleWindow 40)

SYMPTOMS

Rolled every hour while infected (sandbox *ShowSymptoms*):

Infection	Chance / hour	You hear
early	15%	"Chills."
inside the window	35%	"I am sweating and my wound burns."
past the window	50%	"Fever. My head is pounding."
late	60%	"I can barely stand. It is in my blood."

WARNING By default you are **not told** whether the surgery cured you (sandbox *RevealOutcome*). Watch the symptoms: if the fever stays, it was too late or the bite that matters is somewhere else.

TIP Scratches and lacerations can carry the virus too, just less often than bites. Examine them before you reach for the saw.

FIELD SURGERY

Starting it

HOW TO START

On yourself: right-click a saw in your inventory > **Amputate** > choose the limb.

On yourself or another player: health panel > right-click the body part > **Amputate** > choose the saw (or drag the saw onto the part). The patient must stay within 3 tiles and not move.

- Arms: **hand, forearm, upper arm**. Legs: **foot, lower leg, thigh**. Cutting higher also removes everything below.
- You cannot cut your own upper arm or thigh: someone else must do it (sandbox *SelfAmputationHigh* allows it).
- Rings, gloves and watches on the lost part drop; the item in that hand is unequipped.
- The severed limb drops on the floor (it rots like food).

THE SURGERY WINDOW

Nothing happens until you confirm. The window lists each step as **[+]** ready, **[~]** partial or **[-]** missing, with what is missing, warnings (tired, shaking hands, drunk, one hand, fainting) and, if your First Aid is 3+ or you know the surgery, the **estimated risk** and **chance of fainting**. It ends with *There is no going back.* and the buttons **Operate** / **No**.

YOU WILL NEED

(click for the full checklist)





WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU PRESS OPERATE

Action	Needs	Notes
Prepare the area	disinfectant	One dose is used. Starts the wound clean.
Incision	a blade	Pain, blood, a little noise.
Sawing (the long one)	the saw	Animation of sawing a log. 3 screams. Faint roll at half way.
Stitch + bandage	needle/thread, bandage	Vanilla stitching and bandaging on the stump.

The severed limb is an item: what happens next.

FIELD SURGERY

The checklist

THE CHECKLIST

Tick the boxes while you gather the kit (they really tick).

☐ 1 

Tourniquet worn on that limb
Arm tourniquet for arms, leg tourniquet for legs. Missing: heavy bleeding, +15% failure.

☐ 2 

Disinfect
Disinfectant (best), alcohol wipes, alcohol bandage or sheets, whiskey, vodka. Missing: dirty wound, +4%.

☐ 3 

Anaesthesia
Painkillers (up to 60%), alcohol (up to 50%), sleeping pills (up to 30%). OK at 50%+. Less pain = fewer screams, fainting less likely.

☐ 4 

Blade for the incision
Scalpel / kit (best), hunting / kitchen / small knife, then flint knife, machete, cleaver… Missing: +8%.

☐ 5 

Saw for the bone
Bone saw / kit (best), saw, garden / small / plank saw, then machete, hatchet, hand axe (crude, +25%).

☐ 6 

Stitches
Suture needle, or needle and thread. Missing: the stump bleeds longer, +10%.

☐ 7 

Bandage
Alcohol bandage, bandage, alcohol or plain ripped sheets.

THE FIELD SURGERY KIT



Counts as the best saw **and** the best blade. Assemble it (needs the guide read): bone saw + scalpel + suture needle + tweezers + arm tourniquet. You can unpack it again.

TOURNIQUETS



Arm: 2 ripped sheets (or denim/leather strips) + a stick, branch, pencil or spoon. Or a belt + a stick.



Leg: 3 strips + a stick, or a belt + a stick.
Right-click > *Put tourniquet on…*

TIP Hospitals and clinics have bone saws, scalpels and suture needles. A doctor friend in multiplayer can do the surgery on you, even above the elbow or knee.

FIELD SURGERY

Risk, screams, fainting, outcome

RISK

The base failure chance depends on the limb:

Limb	Base
Hand	8%
Forearm	12%
Upper arm	20%
Foot	10%
Lower leg	16%
Thigh	26%

- Missing steps and worse tools add to it (see the checklist).
- Knowing the surgery: -8%. Each First Aid level: -2.5%.
- On yourself: +12% (+15% more above the elbow/knee).
- One-handed surgeon +10%, hemophobic +10%; tired, panicking or drunk adds more.
- Sandbox *SurgeryRiskMultiplier* scales everything.

SCREAMS & FAINTING

- Three screams while sawing if the patient is in pain, each heard up to **25 tiles** (sandbox *ScreamRadius*), less with anaesthesia. With little pain: just a groan (3 tiles).
- The saw itself is heard 5 tiles away.
- Fainting is rolled half way through the sawing. More pain = more likely; a tourniquet lowers it.
- **Fainting on yourself:** *Everything goes black…* The limb is NOT removed: you get a deep, bleeding wound (a *botched attempt*). Treat it and try again.
- **Patient faints** while someone else operates: the surgery goes on, in silence.



THE OUTCOME

Result	Stump
Clean cut	Normal healing.
Rough	Heals 1.4x slower, dirtier, bleeds more.
Botched (something tore)	Heals 1.8x slower, very dirty, bleeds hard.

CAUTERIZE

Right-click a lit stove, fireplace, barbecue or campfire > **Cauterize** > the stump. It closes at once and sepsis becomes much less likely. Hurts a lot and you scream. Needs guts: Brave or Desensitized, Strength 6+, painkillers/alcohol, or knowing the surgery. Take the prosthesis off first.

> **GOOD TO KNOW** In multiplayer the result is rolled on the server with its own copy of both inventories: no cheating the dice.

AFTER THE OPERATION

THE FIRST DAYS

State	How long	Effect
Shock	about 1 day (longer if it went badly)	All actions 1.3x slower; endurance capped.
Convalescence	5 days (sandbox *ConvalescenceDays*)	Actions 1.1x slower; more tired, hungry and thirsty.
Phantom pain	6-30 h after, then every 8-48 h	"The limb that is not there hurts."

HEALING (CICATRIZATION)

Stump	Hand	Forearm	Upper arm	Foot	Lower leg	Thigh
Base hours	120	144	192	150	180	240

Faster with the surgeon's First Aid, the best tools and knowing the surgery; slower if rough or botched and while the stump is dirty. **Cauterizing** closes it instantly.

> **WARNING** A prosthesis on a stump that has not closed can make it bleed again. Wait for *The stump has closed.*



THE SEVERED LIMB

Drops on the floor after the surgery (sandbox *DropSeveredLimbs*). It is an item: carry it, bury it, or do not ask. It rots in a few days and makes you unhappy to look at.

SEPSIS

While the stump is open, dirt builds up every hour (blood and grime on that part make it worse; a clean bandage helps). Past **45%** dirt, sepsis grows:

Sepsis	What happens
10+	The stump gets a wound infection.
25+	Pain. "The stump is hot and swollen."
40+	Sickness.
60+	"Fever. The stump stinks. Antibiotics, now."
100	You lose health every hour.

HOW TO STOP IT

+ **Clean Stump**: health panel, on an open dirty stump. Uses a disinfectant (or alcohol bandage). Hurts.
+ **Antibiotics** lower it every hour. Keep a clean bandage on and stay clean.
+ Once the stump closes, sepsis fades. Each missing hand without a prosthesis: 20% less carry weight (sandbox *CarryPenalty*).

HEALTH PANEL CHEAT SHEET

You see	Means
In shock / Convalescence: 2 d 5 h	Post-op weakness, see the table on the left
Cicatrization 40%	How far the stump has healed
Wound Dirtyness 12%	Keep it under 45%
Sepsis 0%	Infection of the stump
Cicatrized / Cauterized	Healed: safe for a prosthesis
Botched amputation attempt	You fainted on yourself: treat the wound, try again

MODULAR ARM PROSTHESES

TWO PIECES

An arm prosthesis is a **base** (strapped to the stump, one model per level: hand, forearm or whole arm) plus an **attachment** on its end, which you can swap without taking the base off.

+ Wear the base first, then the attachment (or use the workbench).
+ Recipes give the left one: it moves to the side you are missing when you wear it, and changes to the model for your stump.
+ Fits the upper arm and the thigh too.
+ **Grip** comes from the attachment: only hands hold things like a hand. A base alone holds nothing.
+ **Two-handed** weapons need a hand attachment (mechanical, medical, cyber) on a base.
+ Your old 3.2 arms convert by themselves into the matching base + attachment.

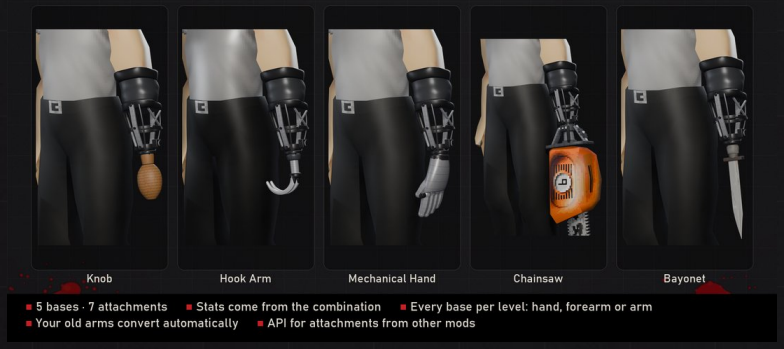
WHAT FITS WHAT

Attachment \ Base	Wood	Scrap	Mech	Med	Cyber
Wooden knob	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
Hook	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
Mechanical hand	NO	YES	YES	YES	YES
Medical hand	NO	YES	YES	YES	YES
Cybernetic hand	NO	NO	YES	YES	YES
Chainsaw (R)	NO	YES	YES	NO	YES
Bayonet (R)	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES

+ Mechanical and medical hands do not fit wood. The cybernetic hand needs a mechanical, medical or cyber base.
+ Chainsaw: metal base only (scrap, mechanical, cyber), right arm. Bayonet: any base, right arm.
+ Messages tell you why: *Doesn't fit a wooden base.*, *This attachment only fits the right arm.*

MODULAR PROSTHESES

A base on the stump and any attachment you like: swap it without taking the base off





MODULAR ARM PROSTHESES

Stats, wear and repair

BASES

Base	Tier	Action bonus	2-handed	Wear	Condition	Weight	Get it
Wooden base	1	+0	with a hand	fast	15	0.8	craft
Scrap base	2	+1	with a hand	medium	22	1.3	craft / clinics
Mechanical frame	3	+2	with a hand	slow	30	1.6	craft / clinics
Medical base	4	+3	with a hand	very slow	40	1.0	hospitals only
Cybernetic frame	5	+4	with a hand	slowest	60	1.2	craft (hard)

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment	Grip	2-handed	Action bonus	Wear	Condition
Wooden knob	no	no	+0	x1.0	15
Hook	no	no	+0	x1.0	25
Mechanical hand	**yes**	yes	+0	x1.0	30
Medical hand	**yes**	yes	+1	x0.8	40
Cybernetic hand	**yes**	yes	+1	x0.7	60
Chainsaw	no	no	+0	x1.5	30
Bayonet	no	no	+0	x1.2	25



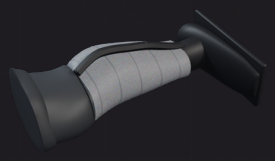
Mechanical frame



Scrap + hook



Cyber hand



Mechanical leg



Cyber leg

WHAT THE NUMBERS DO

- **Action bonus**: counts as extra skill levels for how fast you do things one-handed (base + attachment + your Prosthesis Familiarity).
- **Wear**: every action wears it a little; at 0 condition it falls off (*The prosthesis broke.*). At 3 or less you get a warning.
- **Cybernetic frame**: +1 Strength while worn (only one point, even with two).
- Sandbox *Prosthesis wear speed* (0.1 to 5) sets how fast; *ProsthesisWear* turns it off.

REPAIR

Part	Repair with
Wood, knob, peg leg, crutch	wood glue or duct tape
Scrap base, hook, bayonet	welding rods or duct tape
Mechanical frame / hand / leg	welding rods, screws or duct tape
Medical parts	duct tape or screws
Cybernetic parts	electronics scrap, welding rods or wire
Chainsaw	engine parts, welding rods, duct tape

RECIPES

Arm prostheses

ARM PROSTHESES

All are hand crafts in the crafting menu, no recipe to learn. Welding recipes use blowtorch fuel and welding rods. Click a name in What fits what to see which pairs work.

Item	Skill	Ingredients	Tools (kept)
Wooden Prosthesis Base	Carpentry 2	2 planks, 1 leather strips, 4 nails	hammer, saw
Wooden Knob Attachment	Carpentry 1	1 plank	saw
Scrap Prosthesis Base	Welding 2	1 sheet / scrap metal, 3 leather strips, 2 duct tape, blowtorch, 1 welding rod	hammer
Hook Attachment	Welding 2	1 metal pipe, blowtorch, 1 welding rod	-
Mechanical Prosthesis Frame	Welding 4	3 metal pipes, 1 sheet metal, 4 screws, blowtorch, 3 welding rods	screwdriver
Mechanical Hand Attachment	Welding 4, Mechanics 2	1 metal pipe, 1 sheet metal, 6 screws, blowtorch, 1 welding rod	screwdriver
Chainsaw Attachment	Welding 5, Mechanics 4	4 engine parts, 2 small sheet metal, 1 metal pipe, 6 screws, 1 saw, blowtorch, 3 rods	welding mask, screwdriver, wrench
Bayonet Attachment	Welding 2	1 knife (hunting, kitchen, flint, butterfly, large), 1 scrap metal, 1 duct tape, blowtorch	hammer
Cybernetic Prosthesis Frame	Welding 7, Electrical 6, Mechanics 5	2 sheet metal, 2 aluminium, car battery charger, amplifier, 6 electronics scrap, 4 wire, 10 screws, blowtorch, 4 rods	welding mask, screwdriver
Cybernetic Hand Attachment	Electrical 7, Mechanics 6, Welding 4	motion sensor, pager / calculator / remote, 1 aluminium, 5 electronics scrap, 3 wire, 12 screws, blowtorch	screwdriver



Wood + knob



Scrap + hook



Mech + mech hand



Medical



Cybernetic



Cyber hand, gripping

RECIPES & LOOT

LEGS, CRUTCH & WORKBENCH

Item	Skill	Ingredients	Tools (kept)
Peg Leg	Carpentry 3	3 planks, 2 leather strips, 6 nails, 2 screws	hammer, saw
Mechanical Leg	Welding 4	3 metal pipes, 1 sheet metal, 4 screws, 1 leather strips, blowtorch, 4 rods	-
Cybernetic Leg	Welding 7, Electrical 6, Mechanics 6	3 sheet metal, 2 aluminium, car battery charger, motion sensor, 8 electronics scrap, 5 wire, 14 screws, blowtorch, 5 rods	welding mask, screwdriver, wrench
Crutch	Carpentry 1	2 planks, 4 nails, 2 ripped sheets	hammer
Prosthesis Workbench	Carpentry 3	8 planks, 20 nails, 1 sheet metal, 8 screws	hammer, saw, screwdriver

SURGERY ITEMS

Arm tourniquet: 2 ripped sheets / denim / leather strips + a stick, branch, pencil or spoon; or a belt + a stick.

Leg tourniquet: 3 strips + a stick; or a belt + a stick.

Field Surgery Kit: bone saw + scalpel + suture needle + tweezers + arm tourniquet (needs the guide read).

FOUND, NOT MADE

No recipe. Hospital lockers, hospital wardrobes and clinic tool cabinets:

Medical Prosthesis Base

Medical Hand Attachment

Medical Prosthetic Leg

ALSO IN LOOT

- Clinic tool cabinets also hide scrap and mechanical bases, hooks, mechanical hands, peg legs and mechanical legs.
- Crutches: hospitals, clinics, medical storage.
- Never in loot: wooden base and knob, everything cybernetic, chainsaw and bayonet attachments.
- The Field Amputation Guide: clinics, hospitals, bookstores, libraries.


Crutch


Peg leg


Mechanical leg


Medical leg (loot)


Cybernetic leg


Workbench

LEGS, CRUTCHES & CRAWLING

FOUR WAYS TO MOVE

How you move	When	What you can do
CRAWL	Both legs missing, or one missing and no crutch	Crawl on the ground. No running. Stamina drains. You can still fight from the ground.
CRUTCH	One leg missing, crutch in a hand	Walk only, no running. Stamina drains.
PEG	Peg leg worn	Run, but never sprint.
FULL	Mechanical, medical or cyber leg (or no leg amputated)	Normal. The cyber leg runs 10% faster than a healthy leg.

- A leg counts as missing from any leg amputation (foot, lower leg or thigh) without a prosthesis on that side.
- One prosthetic leg and one missing leg: you still need a crutch.
- Crutch: about 1 minute of walking to get tired; crawling: about 40 seconds (sandbox *CrutchStaminaDrain*, *CrawlStaminaDrain*). Characters who start as amputees tire half as fast.
- Leg amputee traits give you a crutch at the start. Recipe: Crutch.



Peg leg



Mechanical



Medical



Cybernetic

NO LEGS? THEN CRAWL

With both legs gone and no prosthesis, the character crawls on the ground.
Zombies will still find you down there.



- Crawler animation in every state
- No running, no sprinting
- One leg: crutch, or crawl
- A prosthesis puts you back on your feet

WORKBENCH & PAINT

BUILD IT



Prosthesis Workbench: crafting menu > Carpentry. Carpentry 3, 8 planks, 20 nails, 1 sheet metal, 8 screws; hammer, saw and screwdriver. It is furniture: place it from your inventory like any other (it is not in the build menu). If the placing cursor does not work, right-click it > **Set up the workbench here**.

GOOD TO KNOW It has a real 3D model, also in 3D / first-person camera mods such as Viewpoint.

USE IT

+ Right-click the bench > **Prosthesis workbench** (you walk to it), or right-click a prosthesis in your inventory while standing within 2 tiles of a bench.
+ Three lists from your inventory and bags: **bases**, **attachments**, **legs** (worn ones are marked).
+ Your character in 3D, and stat cards per arm with a preview of the selection: grip, two-handed, combat speed, action bonus, wear. Green / red arrows compare with what you wear.
+ Buttons: **Fit base**, **Mount attachment**, **Take off**, **Paint**, **Close**. Taking a base off also removes its attachment.



Red



Yellow



Blue

PROSTHESIS WORKBENCH

Furniture you build and place: fit, combine and paint your prostheses next to it





- Carpentry 3: planks, nails, sheet metal and screws
- A real 3D model
- 3D view of your character
- Stats and comparison
- Paint button

PAINT



Black White Grey Red Orange Yellow Green Blue Purple Pink

+ Only at the bench: **Paint** button. Needs a vanilla paint can of that colour (one use) and a **paintbrush**.
+ Bases, attachments (not the chainsaw) and every leg. **Scrape off the paint** to get the original finish back (no items needed).

Vanilla paint cans and a paintbrush: that is all you need.



CHAINSAW & BAYONET

Right arm only

GROOVY.

Ash-style chainsaw attachment: mounts on any metal base



Hand, forearm or whole arm

- Pull-start (Mechanics helps)
- 0.5 L tank: refuel with petrol
- Running, it cuts zombies and limbs
- Loud: they hear it from afar
- Left hand stays free
- Right arm only

MERLE'S ARM.

Merle-style bayonet attachment: scrap metal, leather, duct tape and a bayonet



Hand, forearm or whole arm

- Welding 2: a knife, scrap metal, leather and tape
- Stabs like a hunting knife
- Wears out with use
- Left hand stays free
- Right arm only

GROOVY: THE CHAINSAW

- Right arm, on a metal base (scrap, mechanical, cyber). The right hand holds the mounted chainsaw; the left stays free.
- Right-click > **Chainsaw arm**: *Pull the starter cord* (Mechanics raises the chance), *Stop the engine*, *Refuel from...* any petrol can in your inventory.
- 0.5 L tank, starts empty. About 2 in-game hours idling; each swing burns a bit more.
- Running: cuts through zombies and limbs, heard 20 tiles away (35 per swing). Off: a heavy club.
- It wears out with use; it stalls when the tank runs dry. It cannot be painted.

MERLE'S BAYONET

- Right arm, any base. The right hand holds the mounted bayonet: stabs like a hunting knife, never breaks (the attachment wears instead).
- Anything else you try to hold in the right hand goes to the left hand if it is free and one-handed.
- **Pistols (3.3.1):** equip a one-handed pistol or revolver and it is held in your left hand while the blade stays on the right. Rifles and shotguns still need a real hand.
- Recipe: a knife, scrap metal, duct tape, Welding 2 (recipes).

TRAITS, SKILLS & SANDBOX

AMPUTEE TRAITS

Trait	Points
Amputated Left / Right Hand	+8 / +10
Amputated Left / Right Forearm	+10 / +12
Amputated Left / Right Upper Arm	+20 / +22
Amputated Left / Right Foot	+10
Amputated Left / Right Lower Leg	+14

You start healed and practised: +4 in that side's skill, -1 Fitness and -1 Strength (arms) or Sprinting (legs). Legs start with a crutch. Sandbox *HideAmputeeTraits* hides them.

SKILLS (AMPUTATIONS)

- **Left Side / Right Side**: you get faster at actions with that side missing. XP comes from doing work while amputated (crafting, first aid, barricading, chopping, reloading...).
- **Prosthesis Familiarity**: XP while wearing a prosthesis; adds to the prosthesis's action bonus.
- Without help, actions take up to 2x (hand), 3x (forearm) or 4x (upper arm) longer. Skill levels bring it down to normal at level 10.

CYBERNETIC TIER

Tier 5: armour plates, cable muscles and segmented fingers — arm and leg







Cybernetic hand: closes when gripping
Only on tier 3+ bases

- Welding 7 · Electrical 6 · Mechanics 5
- Rare electronics: charger, amplifier, sensor
- Best bonus, lowest wear
- Arm, hand and leg

SANDBOX OPTIONS (page "The Only Cure+")

Option	Default	What it does
Cure window / Late gamble window	20 / 40	Infection % where cutting always cures / can still cure
First Aid to examine a wound	2	Without it you need the guide
Surgery risk multiplier	1.0	Scales every failure chance
Scream radius	25	Tiles a scream carries
Self-amputation above elbow/knee	off	Lets you cut your own upper arm / thigh
Allow leg amputations	on	
Sepsis / Sepsis speed	on / 2	
Convalescence days	5	
Cicatrization speed	1	Higher heals faster
Phantom pain / Carry penalty	on / on	
Prostheses wear out / wear speed	on / 1.0	0.1 = ten times slower
Crutch / crawl stamina drain	100% / 100%	Experienced amputees pay 50%
Sleeping pills as anaesthesia	30	
Reveal the outcome after surgery	off	Tells you at once if it worked
Enable zombie amputations	**off**	Zombies lose the limb you hit hard
Zombies that lose a leg crawl	on	
Hide amputee traits	off	

FAQ

The questions people ask most

Q. Do I need the original The Only Cure?
No. The Only Cure+ is the whole mod. Do **not** enable both: they share items and save data. "Field Surgery" is part of the name, not another mod.

Q. Where do I find prostheses?
Most are crafted: see Recipes. Medical ones only spawn in hospitals and clinics. Some scrap and mechanical parts also spawn in clinics.

Q. How do I build the prosthesis workbench?
Crafting menu > Carpentry, needs **Carpentry 3**. It is not in the build menu. Then place it from your inventory, or right-click it > **Set up the workbench here**. See Workbench.

Q. Why can't I hold two-handed weapons?
You need a **hand attachment** (mechanical, medical or cybernetic) mounted on a base. A base alone, a wooden knob, a hook, the chainsaw or the bayonet cannot hold them.

Q. Does amputating ask before cutting?
Yes. The surgery window shows the checklist and the risk; nothing happens until you press **Operate**.

Q. Can I amputate a friend? Can a friend amputate me?
Yes, from the health panel of the other player, within 3 tiles. Only someone else can cut your upper arm or thigh (unless the sandbox allows it).

Q. The "zombie amputations" option does nothing?
It is off by default and it is not for practising. When on, axes and long blades can cut off the zombie limb you hit; zombies that lose a leg crawl.

Q. Can I hide the amputee traits?
Yes: sandbox *Hide amputee traits*.

Q. Is it compatible with Viewpoint / Tomb's Player Body / multiplayer?
Yes. The bench has a Viewpoint model; enable the included **TombBody fit** add-on for Tomb's body; everything is validated on the server in MP.

Q. Can I add it to an existing save, or replace The Only Cure mid-save?
Yes (restart the server in MP). Back up your save first. Old arms convert into base + attachment on load.

Q. What if a zombie bites my prosthesis?
A prosthesis is never a target, and wounds on a limb you no longer have are removed. A bite on the stump that is left is a normal bite.

Q. Why can't I amputate my own upper arm or thigh?
Too high to do on yourself: someone else has to do it. The sandbox option *Self-amputation above the elbow and knee* allows it.

Q. Can I fight while crawling?
Yes, you can still attack from the ground. Zombies still find you down there.

Q. How do I paint a prosthesis?
At the workbench: **Paint** button, with a vanilla paint can and a paintbrush.

Q. I wear two prostheses of the same kind?
Recipes give the left one; the second goes to the free side by itself (3.3.4).

Q. My prosthesis fell off!
It broke from wear (condition 0). Repair it before it gets there: see repair.

Q. Build 41?
No. Build 42 only (42.20 or newer).

COMPATIBILITY & SUPPORT

OTHER MODS

- Enable **only one** of The Only Cure / The Only Cure+.
- Not compatible with BB First Aid Overhaul.
- Fancy Handwork and Brutal Handwork have no Build 42 version (their hooks stay and do nothing).
- Reported working: Wounds Overhaul, AHS, Viewpoint, Bandits, large modpacks.
- Modders can add their own bases and attachments (API_MODULAR.md on GitHub).

MULTIPLAYER

- Every body change is checked and applied by the server; the surgery dice are rolled there too.
- You can operate on another player within 3 tiles.
- Safe to add to a running server (restart it). TOC data is wiped when the character dies.
- Admins: right-click a player > *TOC - name* > Reset / Force Amputation.

TOMB'S PLAYER BODY

Enable the optional **The Only Cure+ - TombBody fit**, included in the same Workshop item, and load it after The Only Cure+ and Tomb's Player Body. Stumps and every prosthesis are refitted to Tomb's body with your own Tomb texture (normal, DOLL or NUDE).





FOUND A BUG?

Report it on GitHub issues or in the Workshop comments, with your **console.txt** (in your Zomboid user folder) and a screenshot. Say which prosthesis and which clothing if something clips.

SUPPORT THE MOD

The Only Cure+ is free and will stay free. If you enjoy it you can buy me a coffee on Ko-fi.

Credits: ZioPao and contributors of The Only Cure (GPL-3.0); RabenRabo (body locations); Tomb (Tomb's Player Body, add-on made with permission).

BUY ME A COFFEE

REPORT A BUG